

THE ILM FOUNDATION

Education Group Publication

ORGANIZATION UPDATE:

- Total number of **students sponsored: 44** students (additional 6 students under one time aid)
- Total amount **collected in July: ₹ 68,811**
- Total amount **spent in July: ₹ 77,551**

OUR VISION

To uplift and transform the Muslim society from their educational poverty in the light of true knowledge which leads one back to Allah

PEARLS OF WISDOM

Anas reported Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying Never does a Muslim plant trees or cultivate land and birds or a man or a beast eat out of them **but that is a charity on his behalf.**

Reference: Sahih Muslim 1553a
In-book reference: Book 22, Hadith 12

EXTRAORDINARY TEAM WORK

Namra, Ayesha, and Afia hail from Saharanpur and live in one room rented house. They study in New Era Academy in grades X,VII,V respectively. The girls are well aware of their financial condition and aim to become well educated and financially stable. Namra and Ayesha actively take charge of the household by teaching the younger siblings and managing their studies quite well. They are ambitious girls aiming to go to great heights and financial independence in the future. The Ilm Foundation helps them by paying the school fee for Ayesha, Afia and the tuition fee for Namra. Through a generous donor, they now have another smartphone to help them manage their studies. They have extraordinary faith and are working hard every day. We pray that Allah SWT guides them and helps the girls fulfill their dreams.

[To learn more about the beneficiaries, click here to access the drive link](#)

EARTH'S CARETAKERS: ISLAM AND THE ENVIRONMENT

Our planet is at risk. If human beings continue to contribute to the destruction of the earth, the risk of greater harm increases for every generation. As global temperatures rise, oceans warm, ice sheets shrink, glaciers retreat and melt, sea levels rise, and extreme events – hurricanes, tsunamis, flooding, droughts, blizzards, and wildfires – we will continue to see the effects of human agency on the natural world around us.

First, as Muslims we must undoubtedly recognize that the earth and everything upon it is entrusted to us. We are *khulafā'* – caretakers and vicegerents – on earth. With our free-will, we hope to pass the test for which we were created and that includes taking good care of the earth and its environment.

Allah ﷻ says

الَّذِي خَلَقَ الْمَوْتَ وَالْحَيَاةَ لِيَبْلُوَكُمْ أَيُّكُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا وَهُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْغَفُورُ

“[He is the One] Who created death and life in order to test you to see who is best in conduct, and He is the All-Mighty, the Ever-Forgiving (Qur'an 67:2).”

Being best in conduct, for us, comes from belief in objective truth coming from God, the supreme source. It also comes from morality that derives from that truth, having integrity and the self-awareness to direct our free will in a way that protects and preserves rather than neglects or violates.

We read in the Qur'an,

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلٰٓئِكَةِ اِنِّىْ جَاعِلٌ فِى الْاَرْضِ خَلِيْفَةًۭ ۚ قَالُوْۤا اَتَجْعَلُ فِیْهَا مَنْ یُّفْسِدُ فِیْهَا وَیَسْفِكُ الدِّمَآءَ وَنَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ وَنُقَدِّسُ لَكَۙ قَالَ اِنِّىْۤ اَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُوْنَ

“And when your Lord said to the angels, ‘I am going to place a vicegerent on earth,’ they said, ‘Will You place in it someone who will spread corruption there and shed blood, while we glorify Your praises and proclaim Your holiness?’ He said, ‘I know what you do not know’”
(2:30).

The angels were concerned about a human creature with free-will that would spread corruption in this world, but there is wisdom in the creation of agents with free-will who choose to do good, guided by objective morality, and striving for justice and the fulfillment of rights throughout their lives. Allah (SWT) commands us,

وَلَا تُفْسِدُوْۤا فِى الْاَرْضِۙۤ بَعْدَ اِصْلَاحِهَاۚ وَادْعُوْهُ خَوْفًا وَطَمَعًاۚ اِنَّ رَحْمَتَ اللّٰهِ قَرِيْبٌۭ مِّنَ الْمُحْسِنِیْنَ

“Do not cause corruption on the earth, after it has been set in order...” (7:56).

Unfortunately, the corruption (*fasād*) mentioned in this verse is precisely what we see in our lifetimes and have historically observed. The destruction of the environment, evident all around us, in addition to the violating of peoples' rights, is nothing other than the *fasad* that Allah warns us to avoid.

Many of the harms we see in the environment are a result of our own actions, and oftentimes Muslims don't realize the responsibility upon their shoulders in addressing environmentalism from an Islamic paradigm. We are approximately twenty-five percent of the world's population and we certainly can make a difference in preserving the environment if we truly wanted to.

What Part Can Every Muslim Play?

First, do not waste resources. While conservation has many facets, the very least every Muslim can commit to is to avoid wasting within their own homes and environments. Wastefulness includes disposing of a significant amount of food that could have benefited others, using packaging and material that harms the environment and remains for years in the oceans, and engaging in an excessive form of hyper-consumerism that is indulgent, extravagant, and neglectful of using income and wealth to help others.

Allah commands us:

يَبْنَىْ ءَاَدَمَ خُذُوْا زِيْنَتَكُمْ عِنْدَ كُلِّ مَسْجِدٍ وَكُلُوْا وَاشْرَبُوْا وَلَا تُسْرِفُوْا اِنَّهٗ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُسْرِفِيْنَ ﴿٧٣١﴾
“O Children of Adam! Dress well whenever you are at worship. Eat and drink, but do not waste. Surely He does not like the wasteful” (7:31).

Second, emphasize the importance of trees. One of the greatest continuous charities is that of planting a tree. It is known from numerous authentic narrations that planting a tree is a virtuous deed for a number of reasons.

Third, recognize the nations of animals as communities. These communities live according to a divine ordering and measure, with a necessary ecological harmony, for purposes and wisdom we may not always fully understand.

Fourth, strive to implement change at all levels. Having started on the individual level, we can expand our scope of action in a number of ways, including the following suggestions:

1. **Discuss** actions you can take with your family within your home. If you live alone, write out some suggestions for yourself and begin implementing your plans, and consider reaching out to a friend or group of friends to help one another with implementation strategies.
2. **Reach out** to local organizations such as your Islamic Center and ask what measures are in place to prevent waste and environmental harm. If nothing is in place, offer suggestions, guidelines, and resources that may incentivize the organization and its members to become more active regarding the environment.
3. **Share** with others what you learn about protecting the earth and the environment.

Finally, we should keep the remembrance of Allah ﷻ always in our minds, hearts, and on our tongues. We should seek His guidance, accept responsibility for vicegerency on the earth, and pray that our actions are continuously rewarded by Him.